THE SOUTH

THE INDIA TODAY SOUTH CONCLAVE SAW LEADERS FROM POLITICS



BHATTI VIKRAMARKA MALLU

Deputy Chief Minister, Telangana

"CEC Gyanesh Kumar should step down and the government must apologise to the nation"

"Bihar and UP get Rs 2-3 for every rupee they give to the Centre, but Telangana only 43 paisa"

"I am appealing to who left Congress to return so we can work without divisive politics"

The five southern states—Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Telangana and Andhra Pradesh—form a powerful economic bloc contributing nearly one-third of India's GDP, representing remarkable cultural and political diversity. The India Today Conclave South, held in Kochi on September 29 and 30, brought together leaders from politics, business, defence, education, cinema, art and culture to explore the region's role in India's future.

Defence got top billing, with experts from Astra Microwave Products, NewSpace Research and Technologies and the Defence Research and Development Organisation highlighting the South's contribution to indigenous manufacturing. Indian Coast Guard director general Paramesh Sivamani spoke about strengthening maritime security through AI.

Political sessions examined caste census, reservation, electoral reforms, youth politics, and faith and politics, as well as the contentious ques-

Photographs by CHANDRADEEP KUMAR